Revision Date:
03/01/2025

Background:
All CalFresh applications must be dispositioned within certain timeframes to meet timely processing guidelines.

Purpose:
This section provides guidance on denials, withdrawals and granting cases. The section is being revised to include clarification of benefits issuance for households (HHs) who apply and are granted after the 15th of the month.

Policy:
1. Denial
Deny CalFresh applications as follows:

If the denial is due to…	then deny the case…
failure to complete the intake interview**,**	on the 30th day
failure to provide verifications**,**	on the 30th day. If the Verification Check List (VCL) due date is after the 30th day, allow customer the date on the VCL.
the HH is not meeting eligibility requirements or refusal to cooperate with the application process**,**	as soon as possible but no later then the 30th day.

Note: Refer to CalFresh Program Guide (CFPG) 63-109 Time Limits and Delays for situations regarding delayed actions.

Send a denial Notice of Action (NOA) to the HH as soon as it is determined that a denial action is appropriate. Refer to CFPG 63-303 Notice of Action for more information. The NOA must be in the HH's primary language when the notice is made available by the California Department of Social Services (CDSS) and must state, in easy-to-understand language the:
- Denial reason.
- HH's right to request a state hearing.
- Title of the state regulation on which the denial is based.
- Availability to free legal representation.
- Phone number to call for additional information.

2. Withdrawal
Applications cannot be withdrawn after eligibility has been determined. HHs may voluntarily withdraw an application any time prior to the determination of eligibility. A withdrawal can only be initiated by the HH. Do not advise or suggest that the customer withdraw an application. When a HH withdraws an application:
- Attempt to contact the HH and document that contact was made (or attempted) to confirm the withdrawal.
- Document the reason for the withdrawal, if any was stated by the HH.

- Advise the HH of their right to reapply at any time.
- Send Notice of Withdrawn Application (CW 10).

3. Granting

Grant and issue CalFresh benefits as soon as possible after eligibility is determined. Granting and issuance must follow the regulations and timelines specified in CFPG 63-105 Expedited Services and CFPG 63-109 Time Limits and Delays. HHs that apply for benefits after the 15th of the month and are found eligible will receive benefits for the initial and the subsequent month of aid on the same day. Once eligibility is determined and approved, send a NOA informing the HH the:

- Application is approved.
- Certification period.
- Benefit allotment.
- Right to a fair hearing.

If application processing is delayed beyond 30 days due the fault of the HH, prorate the CalFresh benefit amount from the date the HH submits all required verifications.

Note: HHs are to be provided a copy of the Statement of Facts (SOF) and Statement of Facts Notification (09-105 HHSA) when the interview is complete.

References:

Manual Policies and Procedures (MPP) 63-300.3, 63-301.2, 63-301.3, 63-301.546
All County Information Notices (ACIN) I-08-03, I-48-03

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 02/29/2028.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services